

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | CrowdStrike | KQL

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Detection Engineer with over five years of experience developing, testing, and deploying detection content across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM. I specialise in writing and optimising detection logic using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and have hands-on experience with Splunk and Security Processing Language (SPL) for threat monitoring and data analysis. My approach to detection engineering is grounded in the MITRE ATT&CK framework, translating adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) into actionable, high-fidelity detection rules that reduce false positives and improve Security Operations Centre (SOC) efficiency. I have practical experience designing and implementing Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Logic Apps, automating alert triage and enrichment to reduce analyst workload. I am proficient in PowerShell scripting for security automation, and I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification. I am eligible for Security Check (SC) clearance and am committed to the engineering-led improvement of defensive security operations in a government or critical sector environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel (strong) | Kusto Query Language (KQL) - Strong | CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM (Expert) | Splunk / Security Processing Language (SPL) - Moderate | Alert tuning and false-positive reduction
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-based detection design | Use case development | Detection content lifecycle management | Security event correlation | SIEM data model design
- **SOAR and Automation:** Logic Apps SOAR automation | Automated playbook development | Alert enrichment and triage automation | PowerShell scripting | Python (basic)
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, EDR) - Expert | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) - Strong | Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) | Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender
- **Threat Intelligence and Hunting:** Threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel | MITRE ATT&CK framework application | Indicator of Compromise (IoC) analysis
- **Cloud and Infrastructure Security:** Microsoft Azure | Microsoft 365 (M365) security | Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD) | Conditional Access
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) | Tenable.io | AppCheck | Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61 | MITRE ATT&CK | NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) | CIS Controls | ISO 27001 | Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst and Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike NG-SIEM - Present

Developed and deployed detection logic across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, translating monitoring requirements and threat intelligence into high-fidelity, actionable detections.

- Write and optimise detection logic using Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel, building analytics rules, alert rules, and hunting queries aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Tune alerts across the Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) stack to reduce false positives, improve signal-to-noise ratio, and increase Security Operations Centre (SOC) efficiency.
- Design and implement Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Logic Apps, automating alert triage, threat enrichment, and incident containment actions.
- Conduct structured threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, applying MITRE ATT&CK-based hypotheses to identify adversary activity across endpoint and identity telemetry.
- Manage the full SIEM lifecycle including data ingestion, log source onboarding, data normalisation, and detection content maintenance across Microsoft Sentinel.

- Develop and maintain PowerShell scripts to automate security event enrichment, alert context gathering, and compliance reporting.
- Lead incident response operations aligned to NIST 800-61, acting as the technical escalation point for high-severity incidents requiring deep SIEM and EDR investigation.
- Collaborate with IT operations teams to identify new log sources, improve data model coverage, and extend detection capability across cloud and on-premises environments.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 Investigated security alerts generated by CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), applying structured analysis to distinguish true positives from false positives. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Built and refined detection rules and analytics in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), improving detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud workload telemetry.
- Supported deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the 8,000-user estate, ensuring consistent telemetry coverage for detection.
- Conducted threat hunting activities using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, creating hunt hypotheses based on current threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate routine alert enrichment, event correlation, and security reporting tasks.
- Maintained detection content documentation and contributed to the ongoing review and improvement of existing detection rules to reflect evolving threat actor behaviours.
- Participated in tabletop exercises and incident simulations, applying NIST 800-61 procedures to ensure structured and effective incident response.

HGX Solutions Ltd (SatS/FinTech) | IT Engineer, Security, Quality, and Infrastructure
 Implemented and maintained security controls across a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, including endpoint protection and network security monitoring. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Supported security event monitoring and incident triage, contributing to the early identification of security anomalies and escalation to senior engineering teams.
- Maintained security policies and contributed to infrastructure quality assurance aligned to regulatory and industry security standards.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection library using Kusto Query Language (KQL), increasing detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-priority threats.
- Built SOAR automation playbooks using Logic Apps that automated alert triage and enrichment for over 60% of common alert types, significantly reducing manual analyst effort and improving response consistency.
- Applied MITRE ATT&CK framework to map existing detection gaps, prioritise new use case development, and produce a structured detection roadmap for the security engineering function.
- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000+ users, establishing consistent endpoint and identity telemetry coverage for SIEM detection.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme to validate detection content effectiveness, identifying and remediating coverage gaps in the SIEM detection library.
- Developed PowerShell-based automation that reduced manual security event enrichment time by standardising context gathering across CrowdStrike, Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender data sources.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Farnborough/Remote)